



GDD 18

Norm Storm

Which norms help, which harm

The social-norms game for ages 9-12, built to the mechanic-embodiment standard. Children sort the swirling "unwritten rules" around them into the ones that help everyone and the ones that quietly harm, learn that people made them (so people can change them), and rehearse questioning the harmful ones, respectfully. Seven mechanics, 22 voice-and-choice moments, zero "tap the right card". Scorecard: passed.

Which norms help, which harm.

Norm Storm is the social-norms game. Children learn that a norm is an unwritten rule a group just follows, that some norms help everyone (kindness, queuing, consent) while others quietly harm (the gendered "girls can't", "boys must"), and that because people made these norms, people can change them. It takes the fairness instinct from Flip the Script (g17) up a level, from spotting a single stereotype to understanding the whole web of norms it sits in. New v2 build to the standard.

FIELD	VALUE
Node / gameld	g18 · norm-storm (confirm exact id against engine-host)
Chapter / ages	Chapter 3 · ages 9-12 · light canvas · solo or peer
Thread / topics	E · Gender & Respect · UNESCO 3.2, 2.3
Prerequisite / builds on	g17 (Flip the Script) · builds on g17
Gating	Core
Schema / status	v2 · scorecard PASS the sort-led norms game.

84

scenarios

7

mechanics

20

help/harm sorts

22

voice & choice

0%

binary taps

The age "log kya kahenge" bites.

From the Chapter 3 personas. By 9-12, "what will people say?" starts steering real choices, this game hands children a way to sort which norms are worth keeping and which to question.

PERSONA	WHAT THEY NEED HERE	THE MECHANIC THAT SERVES IT
Diya, 11 ("is this fair?")	To name the gendered norms boxing her in, respectfully.	sort + role-play : harm-check; question it.
Aarav, 12 ("be a man")	To see the "tough provider" norm harms boys too.	strike-rewrite : flip the boy-norm.
Asha, 24 (peer educator)	To model respectful, collective norm change.	branch : change starts small.
Rohit (father)	The "men don't do housework" norm, re-sorted.	sort + match : helpful vs harmful.
Every child	A test for any norm they meet.	sort + reflect : the good-norm test.

Why this works (the evidence). A social norm is an unwritten rule a group follows, made by people, not by nature, and changing over time. Some norms help everyone (kindness, fairness, hygiene, consent); some harm by limiting or ranking a group, especially gendered norms. Harmful norms can be questioned respectfully and changed, many once-common norms in India (child marriage, untouchability, barring girls from school) already have. Sorting helpful from harmful, then testing for fairness, is the durable skill.

Seven moves, led by the sort.

The rework's heart: norm-literacy arrives through seven actions, and this is the game where **sort** rightly leads, the core move is sorting the storm of norms into helpful and harmful. Mechanics rotate; the same one never runs twice in a row.

MECHANIC	THE CHILD DOES	EMBODIES	N
sort (help/harm) signature	Sorts norms: helpful vs harmful, norm vs fact, passes vs fails the test.	Telling helpful from harmful.	20
strike-rewrite	Flips a harmful norm to a fair one ("girls don't need school" → "every girl does").	Conceptual change.	16
branch	Decides what to do faced with a harmful norm.	Acting for change.	13
reflect	Considers where norms come from and which to question first.	Origins; agency.	12
spot	Catches a norm at work in a scene, dinner, queue, TV serial.	Norm awareness.	9
role-play (voice)	Answers "log kya kahenge" and questions norms respectfully.	Respectful challenge.	9
match	Pairs a norm to who it helps or harms.	Cause & effect.	5

20 help/harm sorts drive the game; **22 of 84** moments are branch or role-play. Binary "tap the right answer": **0%**.

The two-test, passed.

Is it fun?

Norm Storm plays like calming a swirling storm: unwritten rules blow past, and you sort them, helpful ones into the "keep" sky, harmful ones into the "question" pile, then get to flip the harmful ones into something fair. The "is this a norm or a fact?", "does this help or harm?" sorting is quick, satisfying and a bit detective-ish, and the respectful "log kya kahenge" comebacks make questioning feel doable rather than rebellious.

Is it teaching?

Yes, norm-literacy: what a social norm is, that people made them and can change them, how to tell helpful norms from harmful ones with a fairness test, and how to question the harmful ones respectfully.

The belief it moves. From "that's just how it's always been; if everyone does it, it's right; questioning a norm disrespects elders; one kid can't change anything" → "people made these norms, some help and some harm, I can test them for fairness and question the harmful ones, kindly, and change starts small."

Built, not bolted on.

84 researched scenarios across the understand → sort → test → change arc, grounded in real Indian family and community life. Full library in the companion JSON.

CATEGORY	N	LEAD MECHANICS	COVERS
What is a norm?	13	sort, reflect, spot	Unwritten rules; made by people; norm vs fact, law, taste.
Norms that help	10	sort, match, branch	Kindness, queuing, consent, hygiene; teach them kindly.
Norms that harm	16	sort, strike-rewrite, spot	Gendered limits, period stigma, son-preference, dowry.
Where norms come from	12	sort, strike-rewrite, reflect	History, habit, media, family; norms vary and change.
The good-norm test	14	sort, branch, role-play	Respects everyone? Hurts no one? Fair both ways?
Question it, change it	19	role-play, branch, strike-rewrite	Answer "log kya kahenge"; respectful, collective change.

A sort scenario (norms that harm), verbatim.

```
hook: "Sort: does this norm harm someone?"
"Girls shouldn't go out after dark" -> Harms someone
"Boys must never cry" -> Harms someone
"Be kind to guests" -> Helps everyone
"Sons matter more than daughters" -> Harms someone
relearn: "Norms that limit or rank a group by gender harm people."
```

Full library: [SwipeEd — GDD 18 Norm Storm — Scenario Library.json](#) (84 records, v2 schema).

What this game re-sorts.

NORM-MYTH (UN ERASES)	TRUTH (RE WRITES)	BASIS
That's how it's always been; it can't change.	Norms are made by people and change all the time.	Concept.
If everyone does it, it's right.	Common doesn't mean good; some popular norms are unfair.	Critical thinking.
Girls don't need much schooling.	Every girl deserves a full education and her own future.	Harmful norms.
Periods make a girl impure.	Periods are normal and healthy; no one should be shut out.	Harmful norms.
Dowry is just normal.	Dowry is harmful, and it's against the law in India.	Harmful norms.
If it's tradition, it must be good.	Traditions can be kind or harmful; test each one.	Good-norm test.
Questioning a norm disrespects elders.	You can love elders and still ask "is this fair?".	Respect.
One kid can't change society.	Big changes often begin with a few people questioning.	Agency.

The micro-loop.

1. **Hook.** Lensy: "the storm's full of unwritten rules, which help and which harm?".
2. **Play.** Sort norms (helpful/harmful, norm/fact), or spot one, or flip a harmful one, rotated.
3. **The test.** A norm meets the three-check test, respects everyone? hurts no one? fair both ways?
4. **Flip.** On a harmful norm, UN strikes it and RE writes the fair version.
5. **Apply.** Answer "log kya kahenge" in a role-play, or choose to start a small change.
6. **Sticker.** The Norm-Detective badge; GameDone records once.

Signature surface: the **help/harm sorting board**, drag each norm into its sky, paired with the **strike-and-rewrite** flip carried from Flip the Script. The good-norm test (respect / harm / fairness) becomes the reusable lens for Speak Up (g19) and the wider gender thread.

Question, with respect.

- **Register.** Ages 9-12, matter-of-fact and near-peer; norms are examined, never people attacked.
- **Respect + honesty together.** The game explicitly models that you can love your culture and elders and still ask "is this fair?", so children question without rebellion.
- **Keep the good.** Helpful norms (kindness, consent, hygiene) are celebrated, this isn't "all rules are bad", it's "sort them".
- **Heavy topics, handled lightly.** Dowry, son-preference and stigma appear as norms to question, framed for the age, never graphic.
- **Change feels possible.** "Start small, find others, one voice can begin it", agency without pressure.
- **Access.** Audio-first, offline; India-grounded norms and history; pairs with Flip the Script (g17).

v2 schema, scorecard-gated.

- **gameld. norm-storm** — node.game === GameDone key === registry id (confirm exact id in engine-host).
- **v2 mechanic-embodiment schema**. Each scenario carries type + typed payload; the **sort** renderer (items + bins + key) is the signature, with **strike-rewrite** and **role-play** doing the flip and the voice work.
- **Scorecard-gated**. Passed all eight checks (7 mechanics, sort at 24%, 0% binary, 22 autonomy, 16 UN→RE, 5 personas, 100% completeness). Re-run score_gdd.py on any edit.
- **Reuse**. The sort board and the good-norm test are shared with Fair Play World (g10), Speak Up (g19) and the gender thread, build once, reuse widely.
- **Generated path**. Label/order/thread changes flow through the xlsx + gen-path, never hand-edited path.ts.

Ethics contracts (never traded for engagement): examine norms not people; respect and honest questions together; keep the helpful, question the harmful; handle heavy topics age-appropriately; make change feel possible; made-for-India.

Why this works.

- **Norms are made, and changeable.** Teaching that a social norm is a human-made, place-and-time-specific rule (not a law of nature) is what lets children see harmful norms as questionable, the conceptual key the sort and reflect scenarios turn.
- **Helpful and harmful are separable.** The game's core skill, sorting kindness/consent/hygiene norms from limiting/ranking ones, mirrors how norm-change education works: keep what serves everyone, question what harms a group.
- **Change is real and local.** India's own already-changed norms (child marriage now illegal, untouchability abolished, girls' schooling now expected) prove norms move, so the game grounds "you can help change it" in real, nameable history rather than abstraction.

Citations accompany each scenario in the library JSON. 20 games now v2. Next in Chapter 3: Speak Up (g19, standing up against unfairness).